

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 3)

Page 16 - Introductory (Conclusion)

Q1. Because the book is described as 'a little book on a big subject,' how will the various questions of English literature be treated?

- A. Exhaustively and in great detail
- B. Very briefly
- C. Through extensive footnotes
- D. By focusing only on the 19th century

Answer: B

Q2. Due to space limitations, to what will the book's attention be almost entirely confined?

- A. General literature
- B. The literature of science
- C. Theological tracts
- D. Philosophical essays

Answer: A

Q3. Which of the following is NOT listed as a 'special subject' whose literature will generally be omitted?

- A. Science
- B. Theology
- C. General fiction and poetry
- D. Philosophy

Answer: C

Q4. Under what condition will the literature of special subjects be mentioned?

- A. If the author personally likes them
- B. If there is some particular reason for mentioning them
- C. If they were written before the 15th century
- D. If they were best-sellers

Answer: B

Q5. What will the appended table in the book show?

- A. The birthdates of all authors

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- B. The exact number of pages in famous novels
- C. The rough limits of the periods and their relations with general history
- D. A list of all omitted scientific works

Answer: C

Q6. Why are subjects like theology and philosophy generally omitted from this survey?

- A. Because they are not written in English
- B. Because of the limitations of space
- C. Because they do not count as written works
- D. Because they were banned in England

Answer: B

Q7. How does the author characterize the subject of the history of English literature?

- A. As a 'little subject'
- B. As a 'big subject'
- C. As a 'dying subject'
- D. As an 'irrelevant subject'

Answer: B

Q8. How does the author describe the physical size of his book in relation to its subject?

- A. A little book
- B. A massive encyclopedia
- C. A multi-volume series
- D. A pocket dictionary

Answer: A

Q9. What type of literature represents the primary focus of this specific historical survey?

- A. Specialized academic writing
- B. General literature
- C. Medical journals
- D. Religious sermons

Answer: B

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Q10. What relationship will the book's tabular outline highlight?

- A. The relation between English and French monarchs
- B. The relation between periods of literature and periods of general history
- C. The relation between science and theology
- D. The relation between poetry and philosophy

Answer: B

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Page 17 - English Literature Before Chaucer (Part 1)

Q1. What are the dates given for the period 'English Literature Before Chaucer'?

- A. 1340-1400
- B. 500-1340
- C. 1066-1500
- D. 400-1066

Answer: B

Q2. What was the former practice among historians of the English language?

- A. To consider all early English as identical to Latin
- B. To draw a sharp dividing line between 'Anglo-Saxon' and 'English'
- C. To ignore the Norman Conquest entirely
- D. To classify English as a Romance language

Answer: B

Q3. What two languages united to form the new speech distinguished as 'English' after the Conquest?

- A. Anglo-Saxon and Norman French
- B. Celtic and Latin
- C. Old Norse and Norman French
- D. Anglo-Saxon and Spanish

Answer: A

Q4. How do modern writers view the foundation of the English language?

- A. As essentially a Romance language
- B. As essentially a Celtic language
- C. As essentially a Teutonic language
- D. As essentially a Slavic language

Answer: C

Q5. What term is now commonly used instead of 'Anglo-Saxon' by modern writers?

- A. Proto-English
- B. Old English

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- C. Middle English
- D. Ancient English

Answer: B

Q6. According to the modern conception, when did English literature begin?

- A. With Chaucer
- B. After the Norman Conquest
- C. Far back with the beginnings of the English people on the continent of Europe
- D. During the Elizabethan era

Answer: C

Q7. What concept regarding the development of the English language do modern writers emphasize?

- A. Unbroken continuity
- B. Complete disruption by the Conquest
- C. Total replacement of the old language
- D. Stagnation for centuries

Answer: A

Q8. How does the modern interpretation view what was once called Anglo-Saxon literature?

- A. As a completely foreign literature
- B. As an early form of English literature
- C. As a branch of Norman French literature
- D. As having no literary merit

Answer: B

Q9. In the past, who was often said to be the starting point of English literature?

- A. William the Conqueror
- B. Caedmon
- C. Beowulf
- D. Chaucer

Answer: D

Q10. Who brought over the Norman French language?

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- A. The Vikings
- B. The Romans
- C. The Conqueror
- D. The Celts

Answer: C

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Page 18 - English Literature Before Chaucer (Part 2)

Q1. Who is mentioned as using an early form of English some seven centuries before Chaucer?

- A. Shakespeare
- B. Caedmon
- C. Beowulf
- D. Grendel

Answer: B

Q2. What is the fundamental difference in how we approach reading Caedmon's English vs. Chaucer's English?

- A. Caedmon's English is completely lost, while Chaucer's is preserved.
- B. We must learn Caedmon's like a foreign language, but Chaucer's feels like an archaic form of our own tongue.
- C. Caedmon's English is exactly like modern English, while Chaucer's is foreign.
- D. Both are equally easy to read without study.

Answer: B

Q3. How is Caedmon's literary style described in comparison to ours?

- A. Based on the exact same principles as modern poetry
- B. Based on principles radically different from ours
- C. Mostly written in prose, not poetry
- D. Heavily influenced by Norman French

Answer: B

Q4. Despite the continuous history of English literature, when does the author argue that 'modern English literature definitely begins'?

- A. With Caedmon
- B. With Beowulf
- C. With Chaucer
- D. With Shakespeare

Answer: C

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Q5. Which famous epic is preserved from the Anglo-Saxon poetry period?

- A. The Iliad
- B. The Aeneid
- C. Beowulf
- D. The Canterbury Tales

Answer: C

Q6. What is known about the authorship of Beowulf?

- A. It was written by Caedmon.
- B. It was written by Chaucer.
- C. Nothing is known about its authorship.
- D. It was written by the King of the Danes.

Answer: C

Q7. Where is it probable that Beowulf originally grew up in the form of ballads?

- A. In Normandy and France
- B. In Denmark and South Sweden
- C. In Rome and Greece
- D. In Ireland and Scotland

Answer: B

Q8. Around what century was Beowulf likely fashioned into an epic in England?

- A. The fifth century
- B. The eighth century
- C. The tenth century
- D. The fourteenth century

Answer: B

Q9. What is the religious nature of Beowulf as it stands today?

- A. It is purely Christian with no heathen origins.
- B. It is purely heathen with no Christian influence.
- C. It is manifestly heathen in origin, but as it stands it is the work of a Christian writer.

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D. It is an Islamic text brought by invaders.

Answer: C

Q10. Who was the first monster that Beowulf fought and killed?

A. A fiery dragon

B. Grendel's mother

C. The King of the Danes

D. Grendel

Answer: D